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The Concept of Marinization by Ludwik Janiszewski - To Understand the Influence of the Sea

러드윅 제니츄스키의 해양화 개념 - 바다의 영향력을 이해하기 위한 시도

Arkadiusz Kołodziej*

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Ⅰ. Introduction - The sea is not enough

Although sociological studies of maritime reality have a long tradition, maritime sociology, as a separate sociological sub-discipline still faces some important questions. The biggest challenge of *maritime sociology,* also called: *marine sociology* (Longo, Clark 2016)*, nautical sociology* (Woźniak 1988: 296-297)*, sociology of oceans* (Hannigan 2017)*, sociology at sea*[1)]*, the sociology of people of the sea* (Matejko

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1) This term was used in the title of the international conference: *Sociology at Sea. Culture, Economy and Society in a Maritime Perspective* - Zadar, 27-29 September 2013.

1964), *sociology of the coast* (Osbaldiston 2018) is the problem of establishing the appropriate (nautical) theoretical framework (Cocco 2013: 5).

It should be assumed that the sea as a special environment is not sufficient to define the research areas and research perspectives of separate sociological subdiscipline. The sea itself is a part of nature, which distinguishes *nautical sociology* from traditional (long-established) sociological subdisciplines (e.g. sociology of work, sociology of culture, sociology of the organization, youth sociology or sociology of sport), for which the main subject of research clearly defines their research boundaries (Kołodziej 2015b: 284). Maritime sociology, which remains in close relation to environmental sociology and the sociology of work, is still looking for its identity; identity that would indicate the direction of development for empirical studies. These searches lead us to the question about the relationship between the sea and the land in social sciences. Should we extend the "paradigm of terrestrial sociology" on the maritime reality? Should we implement the concepts of "traditional sociology" for maritime issues? Should we explain marine phenomena from the land perspective? Or maybe it will be more beneficial to create a separate maritime theory to understand the social aspect of the sea.

Searching for the answers to these questions has a decades-long tradition. One of the theoretical proposals, that constituted this tradition of scientific investigation was the "concept of marinization" by Ludwik Janiszewski, in which the maritime reality is not explained from the ground of "terrestrial sociology". The sea (as a natural component of reality) becomes here an important factor of influence. That brings to mind the concepts of *nonhuman actors* (ANT)[2] and the logic of environmental determinism. We will try to show that the concept of marinization cannot be reduced to these perspectives. The article

2) Actor network theory.

presents the main assumptions of Ludwik Janiszewski's theory in a broader theoretical context.

Ⅱ. Background and literature review – Maritime sociology in Poland

Before we describe the concept of marinization, we should outline its foundation; we should describe the atmosphere (a number of key factors) which were conducive to draw the attention of sociologists to maritime affairs. First of all, the change of the length of the sea border should be indicated here (much wider access to the sea, which Poland obtained after the Second World War). This change has resulted in a larger number of maritime communities, greater economic and social importance of the sea (e.g. greater participation of maritime professions in the social structure). Greater access to the Baltic Sea had also an ideological meaning – it could be seen as a historical success, as "a manifestation of historical justice" (Kołodziej, Kołodziej-Durnaś 2017: 220; Janiszewski 1989: 268). The sea, after the Second World War was gaining importance, which encouraged sociologists to study maritime issues (Kołodziej 2015a: 226).

The second important factor which supported the development of maritime sociology in Poland was the institutionalization of science (including sociology) in the coastal areas (Kowalewski 2005: 46). For example, the professional activity of Ludwik Janiszewski, the sociologist whose concept we intend to present, was inseparably connected with the development of sociology in Szczecin[3]. These (nautical) problems were also interesting for researchers from inland sociological centers (e.g. in Poznań). However, the development of

3) A port city in Poland.

social sciences “near the sea” (e.g. in Gdynia, Gdańsk, Koszalin) played in a natural way a key role here (Janiszewski 1971: 134; Janiszewski 1991a: 7-12). Maritime sociology, and within it the concept of marinization, develops through both processes: the social rise of the importance of the sea and the institutionalization of sociology in Poland after the Second World War.

Maritime sociology from the very beginning of its existence in Poland was associated with the category of people of the sea. The subject of its interest were two key social and occupational categories, namely the fishermen and the seafarers. In particular, it should be noted here (in the early period of its development) a significant interest in the deep-sea fishermen. This interest resulted in sociological monographs devoted to the indicated socio-professional category (Polańska 1965; Janiszewski 1967) and it was favored by a number of specific features distinguishing this occupation from other professions. One of them was the influence of the natural factor; it was emphasized that the size of the payment depends on the unpredictable fishing success. This uncertainty (similar to a high risk of work at sea) enriched social life on the ship. Equally important from a sociological point of view were historical changes within the indicated category (changes in recruitment to the profession and changes in fishing technology) (Janiszewski 1991a: 7, 8). These and other features of fisheries were naturally interesting for sociologists. We had to wait a few years for similar sociological study of seafarers (transport fleet) (Milian 1974).

It is important to mark here that although the activity of both professional categories went far beyond the Baltic Sea, this subdiscipline was not called “the ocean's sociology”. This means that the geographic location of the country was more important here than their (people’s of the sea) actual activity. This name (maritime sociology) was also proper for other subjects of interest of that

subdiscipline in Poland. Apart from the people of the sea, it was supposed to deal with maritime institutions and organizations (located on land), maritime social processes and maritime (local) communities (Janiszewski 1985: 18). All of these elements, as we will show further, have significant place in the theory of marinization.

It is worth mentioning that interests of maritime sociologists are not focused at the interface between the sea and terrestrial areas (which would stimulate reflection on ecological issues). The main subject of interest are here coastal areas themselves - understood as land that is located near the sea (in contact with the sea) or on "land surrogates"[4] on the sea. Such a perspective brings Polish “nautical” sociology closer to the sociology of the profession (e.g. studies of the seafaring profession), urban sociology (e.g. research on the port city) or sociology of the organization (e.g. research on the shipbuilding industry). At the same time, however, it moves away from the environmental sociology.

The concept of marinization was the answer to two basic challenges facing maritime sociology - it defined its subject (answered the question about the social context of the sea) and indicated the directions of empirical investigations. In this context, maritime sociology becomes a scientific discipline that studies the social process. It is also worth mentioning that this concept had a significant heuristic potential - it allowed for conducting various studies (different areas of social life) giving them a common theoretical denominator. For example, studies of a fisherman's profession and maritime upbringing gained in this way a clear connection – a common theoretical ground.

4) The meaning of a ship as a surrogate (substitute) of land will be discussed later.

Ⅲ. Theory of marinization – main concepts

The word “marinization” comes from the Latin: *marinus, marina* - which means maritime.

This concept was described by Ludwik Janiszewski for the first time in 1971 (Janiszewski 1971; Janiszewski 1988: 6). “Theory of marinization” was intended not only to describe phenomena but also to discover the regularities that arise between the sea and society. An integral part of it was the assumption that the importance of the sea for social life will be growing. To understand the “concept of marinization” by Ludwik Janiszewski it will be most beneficial to start with the main definitions. Let us look at the original understanding of the process and concept of marinization:

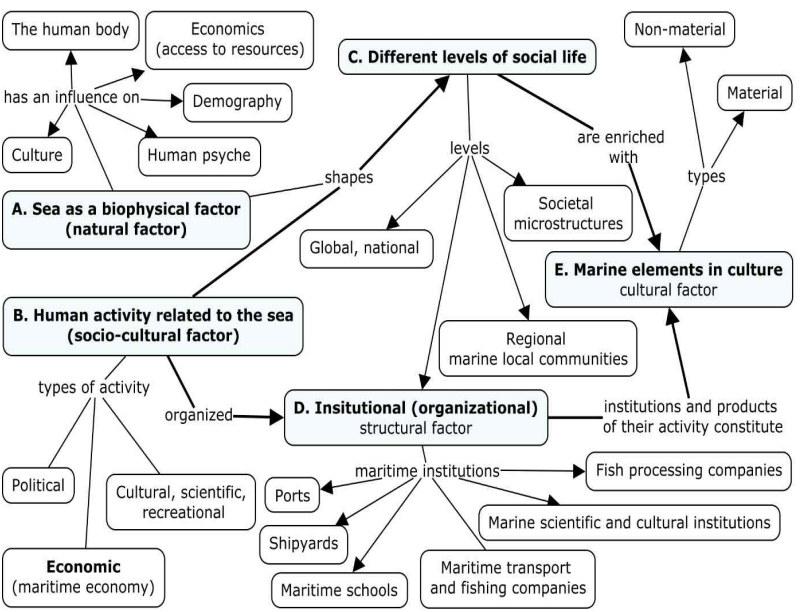
> “[...] the concept of marinization, whose origin is integrally connected with the rise of maritime sociology, attempts to describe and explain the social reality which is shaped by the influence of the sea and the various human activity connected with the sea. Examples of such realities are marine local communities, such as: a fishing village, a port city, a harbour settlement, a maritime recreational or spa resort. These communities differ in geographical and socio-cultural location from other “non-marine” local communities. They are therefore a special type of these communities and a specific ecological unit. According to the concept of marinization, this specificity is shaped by two basic factors: 1 / sea or reservoir as a natural-geographical environment and 2 / human activity connected directly or indirectly with the sea or with these reservoirs”(Janiszewski 1991b: 3–4).

Elsewhere Janiszewski writes: „Therefore, it can be argued that the process of marinization means the formation and occurrence of marine

elements in the material and non-material culture of society. Thanks to this it connects with the state, growth and development of these elements and with the effects they cause in social life" (Janiszewski 1988: 11).

Presented definitions indicate and combine the basic concepts of the theory of marinization. More detailed studies of this theory allow to present it using the following diagram.[5)]

Diagram 1. Basic concepts of the theory of marinization



Source: Own elaboration based on: Janiszewski 1971, Janiszewski 1988, Janiszewski 1989, Janiszewski 1991b, Kołodziej 2015a: 228.

5) An alternative proposal to link the concepts of the theory of marinization has been presented in: Kołodziej A. (2015a), *Zarys koncepcji marynizacji*, "Folia Sociologica" 55, s. 225-238.

Letters from A to E indicate the most important concepts of the discussed theory. In the general terms, we can say that the concept of marinization describes the process within which: Human activity related to the sea (socio-cultural factor) (B) influence on social reality (C) through the appearance of marine elements in material and non-material culture. Let us take a closer look at this and related concepts.

Human activity related to the sea (socio-cultural factor) - In the presented concept, we distinguish two impact factors: socio-cultural factor (B) and the sea itself as a natural factor (A). The role of the first one (*Human activity related to the sea*) is the most significant, this is the main factor changing the social reality through the creation of marine components in its area. This factor consists of various activities related to the sea on an economic, political, scientific and cultural basis. The most important are here the activities in the field of maritime economy. The concept of marinization therefore focuses (mainly) on the impact of professional (economic) activity related to the sea on social reality (Janiszewski 1988: 8). We can, for example, ask here about that: how the work on a seagoing vessel affects the family life of the sea people? In this case human activity related to the sea (work at sea) affects the way of fulfilling family roles (societal microstructures). Another example will be the analysis of the impact of shipyard development on changes in the local community (meso-structure level). The influx of the population (because of the development of maritime economy) will be for example here an indicator of the process of marinization. These examples show how the socio-cultural factor change the social reality.

Less important, but included in the concept of marinization are non-economic activities. We can consider e.g. here how the development of maritime education (maritime upbringing) affects the knowledge of society about the sea.

Human activity related to the sea adopts (thanks to the institutionalization process) specific patterns; it is usually not spontaneous but organized. Hence the distinguished role of maritime institutions (D) which are the frame for human activity. This issue will be discussed later.

Sea as a biophysical factor (natural factor). The second factor affecting the society is the sea itself as a biophysical component of reality (A). The significance of this factor is lower than "human activity" (socio-cultural factor); in addition, its strength constantly decreases with the development of humanity. The direct impact of the sea is visible in five areas (e.g. the impact of the sea on the human body – see the diagram 1). This natural - geographical dependence brings to mind the classic concept of geographical determinism. Janiszewski, however does not accept determinism in its pure form. He assumed that the analyzed factor creates certain conditions of existence. Sea as a natural factor provides potential of action, but it does not decide unambiguously (fully) what human activity will look like (Janiszewski 1989: 269-270). This position reminds us of the perspective of structural constructivist theory, where the structure (simultaneously) creates the potential and the frame of action.

Between natural factor and socio-cultural factor (*Human activity related to the sea*) there is also an inverse relationship - human activity can affect the natural factor (sea) itself. This relation (e.g. degradation of the natural environment), although noticed by Janiszewski, is not an important issue in discussed concept. The sea is understood (primarily) as an invariable factor of influence. Both impact factors (natural and socio-cultural) are here therefore clearly analytically separated.

Insitutional (organizational) - structural factors. Human activities related to the sea are a subject to a process of institutionalization (D). Maritime institutions (ports, shipyards, maritime schools, etc.) and

within them, human activity related to the sea, are here therefore an element of influence (see diagram 1). On the other hand, these institutions and their products constitute marine elements in culture (E). Institutions are therefore, both a factor of influence and the effect of the process of marinization.

If we understand institutions as a structural aspect of reality, then we can say that specific structures produce maritime culture. Structure (social relations) is therefore superior to culture.

Different levels of social life – the range of impact of the process. The process of marinization takes place at various levels of social life (C). The impact factors influence: global society, societies of individual countries, local communities, maritime enterprises, societal microstructures. This process is therefore observed in macro as well as meso and microstructures. The most important for the concept of marinization, however, are the "lower" levels of social life - microstructure and mesostructure (Janiszewski 1989: 278-280; Janiszewski 1971: 145; Janiszewski 1992: 44). The lower the level of analysis, the greater the visibility of the marinization process - therefore, it is most visible at the micro level (the influence of the sea is very significant e.g. in the families of seafarers).

Marine elements in culture - cultural factors. The influence of human activity related to the sea manifests in the social reality through the elements of culture (E). Janiszewski indicates here both material and non-material elements (Janiszewski 1971: 143). For example, a ship will be here a material element, and the lifestyle of seafarers is an example of non-material component of culture; other non-material elements are e.g. value system of sea people, their customs, patterns of behaviour, maritime art, etc. An overview of the basic concepts (and relations between them) allows us to provide the shortest definition of the process of marinization: the process of the emergence (occurrence) of marine elements in culture (Janiszewski 1971: 143).

Ⅳ. Marinization among other processes

Comparing the described process to others we should point out that:

1. This is one of the oldest social processes. It is older than the processes of industrialization or urbanization (Janiszewski 1992: 33).
2. It is a process that encompasses the entire civilization (Janiszewski 1988: 6).
3. It is both spontaneous and intentional process (Janiszewski 1988: 11).
4. It is associated with other social processes (co-exists with other processes e.g. industrialization). Within the process of marinization we can also distinguish other processes, (it consists of other processes) (Janiszewski 1992: 38-39) (see table 1). Separation of marinization from other processes (perceiving it as an independent phenomenon) has only analytical sense – it is a scientific procedure (Janiszewski 1989: 276-277).

Table 1. Types of processes that create the process of marinization

Component processes	**Examples - aspects of the analysis of the marinization process**
Economic processes	Increasing the efficiency of sea exploitation
Technological processes	Modernization of: ports, shipyards, machinery and equipment on the ship
Social processes	Population inflow into coastal areas, creation of new professional structures (appearance of new occupations) within the maritime economy
Political processes	Modernization of the navy
Cultural processes	The emergence of a new system of values and norms among the people of the sea.

Source: Elaboration based on: Janiszewski(1971: 144)

Examples of the process of marinization can be found in various

aspects of social life. In the sphere of economy this may be, for example, an increase in importance of maritime occupations (increase in the percentage of people whose work is related to the sea). In the technological aspect, we can present here (as an indicator of the process of marinization) modernization of the transport or fishing fleet. In the cultural aspect, we will look in the dissemination (proliferation) of knowledge about seas and maritime art; in the social aspect - new customs, life style and aspirations of people of the sea would be important here (Janiszewski 1971: 145). The indicators of the process of marinization are therefore all those changes in which the growing role of the sea is visible: more people in the sea (in the social structure), more effective exploitation of the sea, a greater role of maritime education and maritime upbringing. Some of these indicators are quantitative, which allows us to examine this process in objective terms.

V. Geographical determinism and social actors – the theoretical context of the concept of marinization

Maritime social reality is usually analyzed from the perspective of "terrestrial paradigms". A ship for example is a special type of land - its specificity is determined by the environment in which it is located. The ship is like "a surrogate of land" (Janiszewski 1967: 190), it is primarily designed to create a physical border between the seaman and the sea itself (Casson 1991: 3). It is not surprising then that the ship is considered mainly from the perspective of a total institution (a ship is a maritime example of land institutions) or a social system (a ship is an example of an organization that has already been described on land). We can find similar theoretical relations in the wider analyzes of maritime reality. "Marine actors" participate in land processes:

globalization (Sampson, Wu 2003: 124, Borovnik 2009: 143, 157) or (in the Marxist tradition - *Social Metabolic Analysis*) oppression (Longo, Clark 2016: 463- 479); they are again an exemplification of land reality (e.g. ecological phenomena).

In contrast the concept of marinization deals with the process of affecting the sea (sea factor) on land reality. Marinization (as a process) is not a component of the wider social process - the marinization itself is a broad social process whose impact is both global and local (national, coastal regions). This process manifests also itself in microstructures - where its impact is most evident (Janiszewski 1971: 145).

The perception of the sea in terms of the "impact factor" draws our attention to two different perspectives. First of all, the indication of the natural factor (as an influence factor) draws our attention to the naturalistic perspective of *geographical determinism* (environmental determinism). On the other hand, "activity" of the sea reminds us of the *actor–network theory* (ANT), which allows us to ask the question of considering the sea as a *nonhuman actor*.

Geographical determinism - In Janiszewski's concept, the "marine factor" is a natural, affecting component of reality. Its nature is therefore similar to the natural factors of geographical determinism. However, his whole concept differs from that theoretical tradition.

In geographic determinism, natural factors explain the general social phenomena; they become the cause of a given organization of social life (Szczepański 1961: 210-214). In the concept of marinization, the range of the sea's impact is unknown. The influence of the sea on social life requires therefore proper empirical research. Social life is not fully "naturally" determined here either. The sea is not so much a cause but a kind of conditions on which relatively independent human activity is imposed. In this way, the maritime reality is largely socially constructed, formed at the interface between natural and social factors.

Such understanding of the relationship between nature and broadly understood social structure distinguishes this concept from the simple dependence present in geographical determinism (Mikołajec 2013: 72). No less important is the indication of the second (main) influence factor (human activity), which has entirely socio-cultural nature.

ANT - For a better understanding of the concept of marinization, it is also worth comparing it to the actor network theory. This approach takes into account the impact of nonhumans actors. These entities can be either an element of technology or nature. Thus, the social world is extended here by including new (non-human) elements. Such a change of perspective encourages us to think about the sea as an important actor of many networks. The concept of marinization, with its understanding of the sea as a biophysical factor, is however not consistent with the theory of Bruno Latour. Firstly, Janiszewski's concept has a crystallized structure (its elements are *a priori* defined), which is not in line with the more ethnomethodological (seeking) ANT approach (Abriszewski 2010: IX-XVII). The clear division into natural and socio-cultural factors again does not fit the concept of Bruno Latour, in which all actors in some respects (e.g. the possibility of negotiating the rules of their functioning) are the same (Gdula 2009: 6, 9). The concept of marinization with its clear division into what is natural (and in some sense permanent) and socio-cultural (variable), with a clear definition of social entities, is more classical than ANT.

The sea in the concept of marinization is neither a geographical factor giving the final shape of social life nor an actor of many networks. The influence of the sea is (in some sense) closer to the impact of Bourdieu's habitus. It becomes something between the potential and the factor that causes the pressure.

Ⅵ. Discussion and conclusions

The analysis of maritime reality is usually conducted from the perspective of the "terrestrial paradigm". This reality is land by sea or land at sea. A strong alternative to such a view, which does not reduce the maritime reality to life on land, seems to build a broadly understood structuralist tradition (derived from linguistic structuralism). The maritime reality is then a different space, a different material for the manifestation of the structure of the mind (Deleuze, Guattari 1987: 479). In this way, the maritime reality acquires a sociological specificity.

A certain alternative to the domination of the "terrestrial paradigm" was the concept of the marinization by Ludwik Janiszewski. A concept that not only developed the theoretical base of maritime sociology, but also defined the direction of empirical studies of this sub-discipline in Poland (this process was analyzed within the national research grant in the years 1986-1990) (see table 2).

Table 2. Selected empirical studies related to the concept of marinization

Research areas	**Selected research problems**
Social status of people of the sea	Examination of the social position / prestige of seafarers (status of seafarers' families) (Durka 1991)
Families of the sea people	Patterns of fulfilling parental functions in the families of the sea people (Thurow 1991)
Marriages of the sea people	Analyzes of sources and consequences of marital conflicts (Kaczmarczyk-Sowa 1991)

Source: Scientific studies indicated in the table

The concept of marinization has combined various previously unrelated studies. The factor that combined research in maritime sociology was not the sea itself (which, as it was stated, is an insufficient basis), but a specific social process. Sociologically

unrelated studies, e.g. on the maritime art and the organization of the seafarers' family, gain in this way a common denominator - the process of marinization. The concept of marinization was characterized by empirical inclusiveness. The strength of the concept of marinization was also the assumption of the growing importance of the sea. Nautical issues are becoming more and more important now for sociological considerations.

Despite the indicated advantages, the concept of marinization is not widely discussed today. However, we should not forget about it.

The question about the theoretical basis of research on maritime social reality is currently still open. Any attempts to go beyond the “terrestrial paradigm” seem to be very important here. One of such proposals was the concept by Ludwik Janiszewski, which significantly enriched the thought on the theoretical basis of maritime sociology.

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국문초록

러드윅 제니츄스키의 해양화 개념
- 바다의 영향력을 이해하기 위한 시도

아카디우스 콜로쯔찌

이 글은 폴란드 해양사회학자 러드윅 제니츄스키의 해양화 개념을 소개하고, 그 현대적 의의를 검토한다. 사회적 현실에 대한 바다의 영향을 설명하는 그의 해양화 이론은 최초로 제시된 가장 체계적이면서도 정교한 현대 해양사회이론으로 평가할 수 있다. 그는 해양화를 산업화나 도시화처럼 인간사회가 체험하는 하나의 역사적 문명사적 개념으로 간주한다.

구체적으로 해양화는 다섯 가지 요인들이 (생물·물리적 현상으로서 해양이라는 자연적 요인, 해양 관련 인간 활동으로서 사회문화적 요인, 제도-조직 차원의 구조적 요인, 미시-중위-거시차원의 사회적 요인, 그리고 해양적 특성을 반영하는 문화적 요인) 복합적으로 상호작용하는 경험적 현상으로 이해할 수 있다. 이를 보다 압축적으로 규정하자면, 해양과 인간사회 간의 상호작용이 바로 해양화이다. 해양화 개념은 사회과학적 분석에서 비인간적 행위자로서 해양의 영향력 혹은 조건화 능력에 주목함으로써 최신 현대사회이론인 라투르의 행위자-네트워크 이론과의 유사성도 공유하지만, 부르디외의 아비투스 개념과 더욱 선택적 친화력을 가진다.

주제어: 해양사회학, 해양화(개념화 과정), 러드윅 제니츄스키, 해양, 해양문화

Abstract

The Concept of Marinization by Ludwik Janiszewski - To Understand the Influence of the Sea

Arkadiusz Kołodziej

The article presents the concept of the marinization of Ludwik Janiszewski. This concept describing the process of marinization (the impact of the sea on social reality) was an important element of the development of maritime sociology in Poland. The article presents the main assumptions of Ludwik Janiszewski's theory with its genesis within a broader theoretical context.

Key Words: maritime sociology, the concept of marinization, Ludik Janiszewski, the process of marinization, sea, maritime culture.

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